



MOVE WELL, EVERY DAY

At-Home Mobility Guide

Ten simple drills you can do at home in five minutes. Move better, ease stiff joints, and get more out of every session at Gain.



WHY IT MATTERS

Strength and *mobility* go hand in hand

When we strength train, we put the muscle under a stretch against resistance. That challenge is what drives it to rebuild stronger, giving you more muscle and more strength over time.

Better mobility means more range of movement at your joints, and more range means a deeper, more effective stretch on the muscle when you train. So working on mobility does two things at once: it helps you **manage joint pain**, and it helps you **get more out of your strength work**.

We cover this in your sessions, but just **five minutes a day at home** can make a real difference to how you move and how you feel, body and mind.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Inside are **10 mobility drills**, each shown step by step with photos. You don't need to do all of them every day. For each one we flag the areas it helps most, so you can target what you need.

THE SIMPLE ROUTINE

Pick three drills and run through them 3 to 5 times a week. Even a few the day after a workout will help your recovery.



Please note: these exercises are general guidance, not treatment for a specific injury or pain. If you have a particular concern, seek medical advice, or get in touch and we'll link you with our partnered physiotherapist.

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Ten drills, four areas of the body

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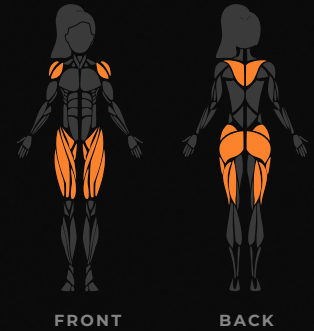
10 Ankle Circles & Alphabet FULL ANKLE

REMEMBER

You only need **three drills a day**. Start with the areas that feel tightest, and build from there.

SECTION 1 • FULL BODY

01 World's Best Stretch



TARGETS

Hip flexors, thoracic spine, glutes, hamstrings, groin and shoulders. One movement for the whole body.

HOW TO DO IT

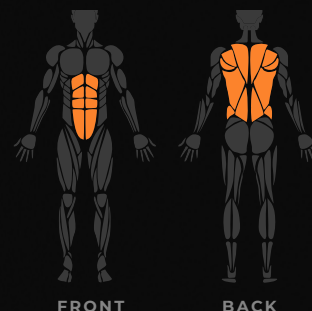
- 1 Start in a press-up (plank) position.
- 2 Step your right foot up to the outside of your right hand.
- 3 Drop your left knee to the floor.
- 4 Reach your right arm up to the ceiling, rotating through your upper back. Follow your hand with your eyes.
- 5 Bring the arm down and repeat the rotation 3 to 5 times.
- 6 Step back to the plank, then repeat on the other side.

PROGRESS IT

Add a pause at the top of the rotation. Once that feels easy, keep the back knee off the floor throughout to ask more of your hip flexors.

SECTION 1 • FULL BODY

02 Cat Cows



TARGETS

The whole spine from neck to tailbone, especially the mid and lower back. Also gently mobilises the hips and core.

HOW TO DO IT

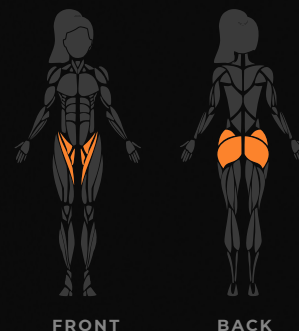
- 1 Start on all fours, hands under shoulders, knees under hips.
- 2 **Cow:** breathe in, let your belly drop toward the floor, lift your head and tailbone.
- 3 **Cat:** breathe out, round your back toward the ceiling, tuck your chin and pelvis.
- 4 Move slowly between the two, matching breath to movement.
- 5 Repeat 8 to 10 times.

PROGRESS IT

Slow it right down and pause at each end. Then add a rotation, reaching one arm up to open the chest (shown right), to mobilise the spine in every direction.

SECTION 2 · LOWER BACK & HIPS

03 90/90 Hip Stretch



TARGETS

Hip rotators, glutes (especially the piriformis) and hip flexors. Directly addresses the tightness that feeds lower back pain.

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Sit with both legs bent at 90 degrees, one in front and one out to the side.
- 2 Sit tall and keep your back upright.
- 3 Lean gently forward over your front shin until you feel a stretch in the outer hip.
- 4 Hold for 30 to 60 seconds, then switch sides.

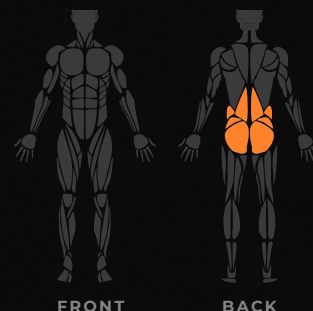
PROGRESS IT

Place your hands on the floor and walk them forward to increase the lean. Progress further by lifting the back knee slightly off the floor.

SECTION 2 · LOWER BACK & HIPS

04 Supine Knee Hug

SINGLE & DOUBLE



FRONT

BACK



SINGLE



DOUBLE



PROGRESSION

TWIST

TARGETS

Lower back, glutes and piriformis. A gentle decompression of the lower spine, ideal for morning stiffness or after a long sit.

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Lie on your back with your knees bent.
- 2 **Single:** pull one knee into your chest, keeping the other foot flat. Hold 20 to 30 seconds, then switch.
- 3 **Double:** pull both knees into your chest and gently rock side to side.
- 4 Keep your head relaxed on the floor throughout.

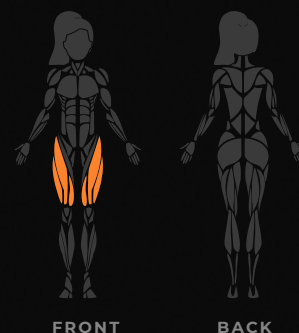
PROGRESS IT

From the double knee hug, add a gentle twist (shown right): lower both knees to one side while keeping your shoulders flat. This brings rotation into the lower spine.

SECTION 2 · LOWER BACK & HIPS

05 Hip Flexor Lunge

KNEELING



FRONT

BACK



TARGETS

Hip flexors and the quad of the rear leg. Tightness here is a major contributor to lower back pain and poor posture.

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Kneel on one knee with the other foot forward, like a proposal position.
- 2 Tuck your pelvis under slightly by squeezing the glute of the rear leg.
- 3 Gently shift your weight forward until you feel a stretch at the front of the back hip.
- 4 Keep your torso upright; don't lean forward.
- 5 Hold 30 to 60 seconds each side.

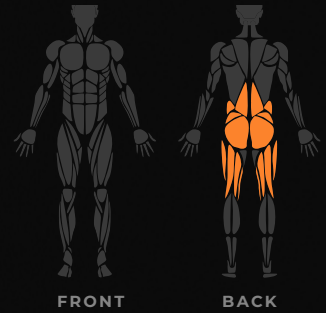
PROGRESS IT

Raise the arm on the same side as the back knee overhead and reach across (shown right). This takes the stretch up into the mid-back and lat.

SECTION 2 · LOWER BACK & HIPS

06 Glute Bridge with Hold

STRENGTH



TARGETS

Glutes, hamstrings, lower back and the deep hip stabilisers. Builds the posterior chain that keeps your spine protected and strong.

HOW TO DO IT

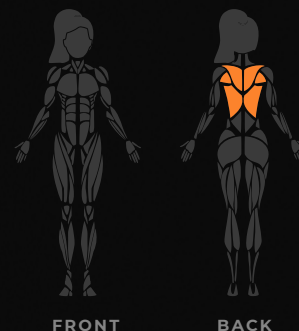
- 1 Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat and hip-width apart.
- 2 Press through your heels and lift your hips toward the ceiling.
- 3 Squeeze your glutes at the top and hold for 2 to 3 seconds.
- 4 Lower slowly; don't just drop.
- 5 Repeat 10 to 12 times.

PROGRESS IT

Hold the top position for longer, up to 30 seconds. Then progress to a single-leg bridge (shown right): extend one leg straight while bridging on the other.

SECTION 3 · SHOULDERS & UPPER BACK

07 Thread the Needle



FRONT

BACK



TARGETS

Mostly the mid and upper back. Excellent for rotation through the upper back, which stiffens up from sitting.

HOW TO DO IT

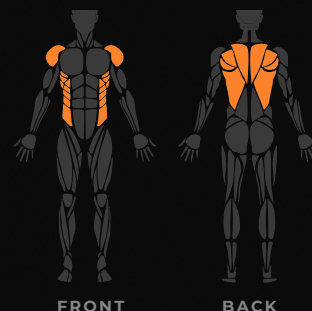
- 1 Start on all fours, hands under shoulders, knees under hips.
- 2 Slide your right arm along the floor under your body, rotating until your shoulder and ear come toward the floor.
- 3 Hold for 2 to 3 seconds.
- 4 Return, then reach the same arm up toward the ceiling to open the chest.
- 5 Repeat 6 to 8 times each side.

PROGRESS IT

At the top of the rotation, pause and reach further, as if to touch the wall behind you. A slight push through the grounded hand deepens the rotation.

SECTION 3 · SHOULDERS & UPPER BACK

08 Wall Slides



TARGETS

Upper back, the sides of the ribcage and the shoulders. Trains the shoulders through full range while keeping the upper back flat, improving posture and overhead movement.

HOW TO DO IT

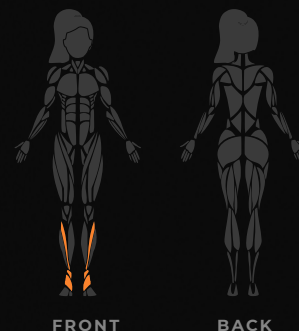
- 1 Stand with your back flat against a wall: heels, bottom, upper back and head all touching.
- 2 Bring your arms up to 90 degrees in a goalpost shape, elbows and the backs of your hands against the wall.
- 3 Slowly slide your arms up the wall overhead, keeping everything in contact.
- 4 Slide back down to the start.
- 5 Repeat 8 to 10 times, slow and controlled.

PROGRESS IT

If staying in contact is easy, pause at the top for 2 to 3 seconds. Progress further by stepping slightly away from the wall so your shoulders work harder to hold position.

SECTION 4 • ANKLES

09 Wall Ankle Mobilisation



TARGETS

Ankle dorsiflexion, the ability to bend the ankle so the toes come toward the shin. Poor ankle mobility affects squatting, walking and balance, and matters for fall prevention.

HOW TO DO IT

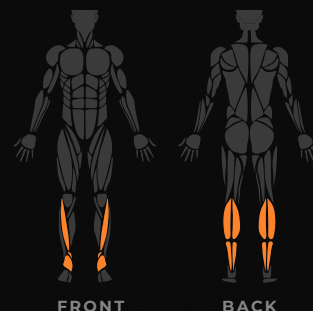
- 1 Stand facing a wall, about a foot away.
- 2 Place one foot close to the wall, toes pointing straight ahead.
- 3 Drive your knee forward toward the wall, keeping your heel flat on the floor.
- 4 Aim to touch your knee to the wall. If that's easy, move your foot further back.
- 5 Repeat 10 to 15 slow reps each side.

PROGRESS IT

Move your foot further from the wall to ask for more range. For a loaded version, hold a light kettlebell at your chest and perform a slow squat, pausing at the bottom.

SECTION 4 • ANKLES

10 Ankle Circles & Alphabet



TARGETS

Every direction of ankle movement, plus the small stabilising muscles around the ankle and lower leg.

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Sit in a chair, or lie on your back with one leg raised.
- 2 Slowly draw large circles with your foot, 10 in each direction.
- 3 Then trace the alphabet with your big toe, making each letter as large as you can.
- 4 Keep the movement in your ankle, not your whole leg.
- 5 Repeat on the other side.

PROGRESS IT

Do it standing on one leg to add a balance challenge. Progress further by standing on a folded mat or balance pad while you circle.

KEEP IT SIMPLE

Three drills. Five minutes. *Most days.*

That's all it takes to start moving better. Bring any questions to your next session and your coach will tailor it to you, **nothing here replaces being shown in person.**

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